

Michael Avery

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SUMMARY

- Senior software engineer with 8 years of professional experience building payment processing platforms. He owns services end to end, from schema design through deployment and on-call, and he mentors engineers and leads delivery for a team of four.

EDUCATION

- The University of Texas at Austin · Master of Science in Computer Science, 2019
- The University of Texas at Austin · Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, 2017

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer | Northgate Payments | Austin, TX | 2021 - Present

- Lead engineer on the payment processing services platform, written in Python (FastAPI), serving 40M+ requests per month.
- Designed and maintained 30+ production REST API endpoints over six years, including versioning, pagination and rate limiting.
- Own the PostgreSQL schema for the core transaction store, including partitioning and index tuning that cut P95 query time from 780ms to 110ms.
- Migrated the platform to Docker containers on Kubernetes, cutting deploy time from 45 minutes to 6 and enabling zero-downtime releases.
- Built the event pipeline on Azure Service Bus, processing 12M+ messages per day with idempotent consumers and a dead-letter workflow.
- Maintain the Azure DevOps Pipelines build and release pipelines for eight repositories, including automated test gates and staged rollout.
- Formally mentor three junior engineers · two of his mentees have since been promoted · run the team's code review standard, and lead a project team of four.

Software Engineer | Lumen Commerce | Austin, TX | 2017 - 2021

- Built backend services in Python against PostgreSQL, growing the automated test suite from 12% to 84% line coverage across unit and integration tests.
- Ran production workloads on Microsoft Azure for four years, including managed compute, object storage and secret management.
- Reviewed 400+ pull requests and established the team's Git branching model.

SKILLS

- Languages: Python, SQL, Bash, TypeScript
- Data: PostgreSQL, Redis, schema design, query tuning
- Platform: Docker, Kubernetes, Microsoft Azure, Azure DevOps Pipelines, Azure Service Bus
- Practice: Git, pull request review, unit and integration testing, on-call

COMMUNITY

- Volunteer, Islamic Center of Austin food pantry · weekend shift, stocking and distribution, roughly six hours a month since 2023.